THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 3

Chapter 10: **Indian Architecture** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which of these best shows technical skill of Harappans? 1

(a) iron plough **(b)** metal tools
(c) uniform baked bricks and drains **(d)** cement

2. The expansion of tall vimanas in the Chola period shows 1

(a) weak kings **(b)** growing resources and engineering skill
(c) lack of stone **(d)** decline

3. Why do temple sculptures matter to historians? 1

(a) they are old only **(b)** they show dress, music and daily life
(c) they are only decorative **(d)** they hold gold

4. A modern architect borrows jalis in a school building. The main reason is 1

(a) money **(b)** natural light and ventilation
(c) religion **(d)** war

5. Why would a stepwell be more useful in a desert than a pond? 1

(a) steps give access as water level falls and shade reduces evaporation
(b) it is cheaper
(c) it is noisy
(d) it is bigger

6. If a building has a charbagh, it is likely to 1

(a) have a garden divided into four parts **(b)** be a stupa
(c) be a stepwell **(d)** be a cave

7. How does the Golden Temple differ in plan from most temples? 1

(a) it is lower than surroundings with four entrances
(b) tall shikhara
(c) cave
(d) stupa

8. Which feature of the Jama Masjid of Ahmedabad shows cultural exchange? 1

(a) Gothic arch **(b)** temple-like pillars and jalis
(c) glass domes **(d)** cement

9. **Assertion (A):** Humayun's Tomb was built in the middle of a charbagh garden. 1
Reason (R): It shows Persian influence and was a forerunner of the Taj Mahal.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

10. **Assertion (A):** The tower above the sanctum is called shikhara in the north and vimana in the south. 1
Reason (R): The Brihadishvara Temple at Thanjavur was built by Rajaraja Chola I around 1010 CE.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How are temple sculptures a source of history? 2

12. How does architecture help us reconstruct history? 2

13. Why do Chola temples have large courtyards? 2

14. Why may two temples of the same period look different? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Analyse the engineering challenge of the Kailasha Temple. 3

16. Assess the contribution of local craftsmen to Indo-Islamic buildings. 3

17. Examine the threats to heritage buildings and suggest remedies. 3

OR

Evaluate stepwells as sustainable water-harvesting structures. 3

18. Examine why forts are built with several gates and bastions. 3

OR

Assess the usefulness of traditional architecture for modern green design. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. **Case study.** The Brihadishvara Temple at Thanjavur was built by Rajaraja Chola I around 1010 CE. The main image is placed in the garbhagriha, over which rises the vimana. Many temples have a pushkarini, a water tank for rituals and water storage. In north India the tower above the sanctum is called the shikhara. 5
(i) Who built the Brihadishvara Temple?
(ii) What is the innermost chamber called?
(iii) What is a pushkarini?
(iv) Compare northern and southern temple towers.

20. Analyse the blending of cultures in Indo-Islamic architecture with examples. 5

OR

Evaluate the symbolic meaning of the architecture of the Golden Temple and Brihadishvara temple. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — **Total: 40 Marks**